

TAKE ONE - Feature Status Summary

Basic project status document generated on 5 May 2026.

What Works Right Now

- User register and login with hashed passwords and JWT token sessions.
- Secure auth middleware so private routes trust the logged-in token, not fake browser user ids.
- Live MySQL-backed users, scripts, profile data, script counts, and search results.
- Profile page loads real user details, scripts, skills, city, and collaboration inbox.
- Profile edit endpoint saves name, role, college, city, bio, skills, portfolio, and avatar URL permanently.
- Directors, writers, and producers can upload scripts; crew roles are blocked from script upload.
- Role-based project interface for directors, camera crew, actors, writers, producers, gaffers, sound, editors, and spot roles.
- Separate crew finder page with search, role filters, city filters, crew cards, and contact links.
- Collaboration requests can be sent for scripts and are stored in MySQL.
- Incoming and outgoing collaboration request lists appear in the profile page.
- Request owners can now accept or reject incoming collaboration requests.
- In-app notifications now appear for new crew requests and accepted/rejected decisions.
- Notifications can be marked read one by one or all at once.
- Optional SMTP email sending exists for collaboration requests when real email settings are configured.

Important Backend/API Pieces

Area	Current Status
Auth	JWT middleware, same-user protection, bcrypt passwords
Users	Register, login, search crew, get profile, update profile
Scripts	Search live scripts, creator-only script upload
Requests	Create request, list requests, accept/reject request
Notifications	List notifications, mark read, mark all read
Email	Nodemailer setup ready, needs real SMTP credentials

What Is Still Left Before Going Live

- Replace the current development JWT secret with a long private production secret and never share the .env file.
- Add stricter validation and sanitization for every form field, especially profile text, search, and request messages.
- Add rate limiting for login, register, requests, and contact/email endpoints to reduce spam and brute force attacks.
- Add password reset, email verification, and safer account recovery.
- Use HTTPS, secure cookies or hardened token storage, and production CORS origins only.
- Configure real SMTP email credentials, test deliverability, and add branded email templates.

- Build real file upload for script PDFs/posters with file type checks, file size limits, and safer storage.
- Add admin moderation tools for reported users, fake profiles, abusive messages, and suspicious scripts.
- Add stronger role permissions and maybe profile verification for serious production use.
- Move database changes into migration files so future changes are controlled and repeatable.
- Set up database backups, restore testing, logs, uptime monitoring, and error tracking.
- Run full testing on auth, profile save, script upload, request accept/reject, notifications, email, mobile, and browser compatibility.
- Add privacy policy, terms of service, user content ownership rules, and contact/spam policy.
- Upgrade notifications later to real-time WebSocket or Server-Sent Events; right now they load in the app when profile data loads.

Beginner Note

The project is now past fake static numbers. The main user journey is: create account, log in, complete profile, upload or find scripts depending on role, request collaboration, accept/reject requests, and see notifications. The biggest remaining work is production security, testing, deployment, real email, and file uploads.